

Make Your PC an Earning Member

Ten feasible ideas to make your home computer pay for itself

That little beige box which sits quietly in your home can do more than you think. You probably use it for fun stuff, games and chat, and maybe to type mail and use the ubiquitous Microsoft Word. You might also be using it to learn new programs, run applications, and to get to know the finer elements. But no matter what you do, the chances of you not utilising your PC fully are very high—your PC is not paying for itself.

We know what the cost of a PC in the market currently is and what with the Internet accounts, phone bills, software and other purchases, the cost turns out to be quite high. So how do you get some of that hard-earned money back? By using your PC and the devices you bought along with it (printers, scanners, CD-Writers, etc) smartly.

What you need to turn your PC into a money making machine is, of course, a PC, loads of time, some essential skill-sets, and 10 really feasible ideas. You've got to have the first three. We're here with the ideas.

1 Communications centre@home

People need to communicate the world over. Cheaper, faster, and more trouble-free the communication, the better. What's better than an e-mail and chat in this sense? For the average Indian without a PC, cyber cafés are always around, but not always the first choice. This is where you step in—not by opening a cyber café but by letting a few customers send/receive mail, surf, chat and take printouts at minimal charges. You will keep your machine clean, healthy and virus-free, teach your customers to do the same, and give some general tips. Afterwards, when your reputation is established, you need not spend all your time there—a younger sibling

could take over.

Start off by getting Webmail, buying a ream of paper, and cleaning up your room.

How much can you earn?

You could charge Rs 10 to 15 for the printout of each e-mail received or sent. With just a handful of customers you could earn yourself good money.

2 Data entry

There's a lot of demand in the market for getting data typed accurately. If you have a good typing speed, proficiency with the English language, time, and tonnes of patience, then this might just be the thing for you.

A lot of companies prefer to outsource data entry tasks rather than employ people for the purpose. This data, which is to be keyed in manually, may be numeric and/or alphabetic as well as in a standard format with specific fields or in free form. You'll need your trustworthy PC, a spreadsheet or a word processor, backups, and an ability to meet deadlines.

There's plenty of work available with companies like Datamatics and there are lots of other companies which outsource data entry on a regular basis. Data entry can get a bit monotonous though, but if you devote a couple of hours to it every day—just like an exercise which you have to finish—then it's possible to earn a decent amount of money over a period of time.

How much can you earn?

The money you earn depends on the field you enter. It usually ranges from 60 to 80 paise per data field. You'll need a few good hours of work everyday to earn you a substantial amount.

3 DTP and word processing

Are you a whiz at Microsoft Word? You along with your PC could be in business typing letters, documents, college projects, etc for anyone who needs

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